

Chapter 3 – Documents Required for TIN Registration

3.1 Introduction

To register for a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, applicants must submit a completed registration application together with supporting documents that verify their identity, legal status, and business information (where applicable). The exact documents required depend on the type of taxpayer.

Applicants should ensure that all documents are complete, accurate, and valid before submission. Where original documents are presented in person, photocopies should also be provided. For online applications, clear scanned copies of supporting documents must be uploaded.

3.2 General Requirements

Regardless of the type of applicant, the following requirements generally apply:

- Completed TIN Registration Application Form.
- Valid identification documents.
- Supporting documents relevant to the applicant’s category.
- Proof of address where required.
- Clear copies of supporting documents for online applications.
- Original documents may be required for verification during in-person registration.

3.3 Documents Required for Individuals (Including Sole Proprietors)

Individuals applying for a TIN should submit the following documents:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed TIN registration application.
National Identity Card (NIC)	Required for Sri Lankan citizens.

Passport	Required for foreign nationals.
Business Registration Certificate	Required for sole proprietors operating a registered business.
Proof of Address	Required if the address differs from the NIC. Acceptable documents include a utility bill, bank statement/passbook, or Grama Niladhari certificate. Foreign nationals should provide local address proof.

3.4 Documents Required for Partnerships

A registered partnership should provide:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed application form.
Partnership Registration Certificate	Proof of legal registration.
NIC or Passport of Every Partner	NIC for Sri Lankan partners or passport for foreign partners.

3.5 Documents Required for Registered Companies

Companies must submit supporting documents proving their legal incorporation and ownership.

Required documents include:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.

Certificate of Incorporation	Company incorporation certificate issued by the Registrar of Companies.
Form 01	Certified by the Registrar of Companies.
Form 05	Certified copy where applicable.
Form 40	Certified copy where applicable.
Form 20	Certified copies relating to directors.
Form 13	Required where applicable.
Form 18	Required where Form 20 is used to recognize directors' signatures.
Articles of Association	Company constitution document.
Directors' Identification	NIC for Sri Lankan directors or passports for foreign directors.
BOI Registration Certificate	Required for Board of Investment registered companies, where applicable.

3.6 Documents Required for Trusts

Trusts should submit:

Required Document	Description
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Application Form	Completed application.
Trust Deed	Official trust document.
Trustees' Identification	NIC for Sri Lankan trustees or passports for foreign trustees.

3.7 Documents Required for Joint Ventures

Joint ventures should provide:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.
Joint Venture Agreement	Agreement between participating parties.
Copies of Partners' TIN Certificates	Where available.
Power of Attorney	Required where applicable.
Project Agreement	Where applicable.
Cabinet Approval	Required for certain government-approved projects.

3.8 Documents Required for Projects, NGOs, and Other Organizations

Depending on the legal status of the organization, the following may be required:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.
Letter of Request	Issued by the head of the organization.
Registration Certificate	Organization registration

	certificate.
Letter of Appointment	Appointment of the authorized signatory.
Minutes of AGM or Executive Report	Where applicable.
Confirmation from Head Office	Required for branch offices.
Gazette or Act	Required for government or semi-government institutions.

3.9 Proof of Address

If the residential or business address differs from the National Identity Card or official records, proof of address should be provided.

Examples include:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Bank passbook
- Grama Niladhari Certificate
- Local address proof for foreign nationals

According to the guidance, supporting documents should be current and clearly display the applicant's name and address.

3.10 Documents Required for Online Registration

Applicants using the IRD e-Services portal should prepare electronic copies of all supporting documents before beginning the registration process.

Supporting documents should be:

- Clear and readable.
- Complete.
- Uploaded under the correct document type.
- Submitted together with the online registration application before final declaration.

3.11 Declaration and Submission

Before submitting a TIN registration application, applicants are generally required to:

- Review the application summary.
- Confirm that the information provided is true, correct, and complete.
- Enter their name.
- Enter their designation (where applicable).
- Provide a contact number.
- Submit the declaration electronically or in person.

After successful submission, an acknowledgement is generated. Applicants are advised to retain the acknowledgement for future reference.

3.12 Important Notes

- All information provided during registration should be accurate and supported by valid documentation.
- Additional documents may be requested by the Inland Revenue Department where necessary.
- Incomplete applications or missing supporting documents may delay processing.
- For online applications, applicants should ensure all uploaded files are legible and correspond to the selected document type.
- Applicants should retain copies of all submitted documents and the acknowledgement receipt for future reference.

3.13 Key Points

- Required documents vary depending on the taxpayer category.
- Individuals primarily require identification and proof of address.
- Business entities require registration and incorporation documents in addition to identification.
- Supporting documents must be provided during both online and manual registration.
- An application is not considered complete until the declaration has been submitted and an acknowledgement has been issued.

